REVISION: Verb forms from this year

Make sure you can remember all of the following points about verb forms from this year. References are given to help you.

Learn the **irregular past participles** from Mich 11

Learn the 16 **verbs which conjugate with être** in the perfect tense from Lent 1

Be able to conjugate all verbs into **the imperfect tense**. Lent 7

More on agreement of past participles

AVOIR. There are three basic cases when a verb taking avoir in the perfect tense will need to make the past participle agree. All of them because of PDO which was studied in Lent 3 and 5.

When an object pronoun precedes AVOIR:
je les ai vus *La pomme? Elle l'a mangée*
When there is a QUE and a descriptive clause in the perfect tense:
les livres que j'ai lus *la pomme qu'elle a mangée*
After COMBIEN DE or (LE)QUEL* before a perfect tense:
combien de filles avez-vous vues?
Lesquelles as-tu achetées?
Quels livres a-t-il achetés?

ÊTRE. The sixteen or so "être verbs" always make an agreement between the subject and the past participle:

elles sont parties. *elle est née en 1965.*

Although ALL reflexive verbs also take ÊTRE in the perfect tense, agreement of these past participles is not automatic. It only happens where the reflexive pronoun is effectively a PDO, i.e. the direct object of the verb. The verb in question must therefore not involve a preposition:

elle s'est lavée *elles se sont parlé.*

This will be covered in greater detail later on.

Nouns: number and gender – *tooth*, *teeth*

To make a noun plural, add "S": There are some **exceptions**:
7 nouns ending in –ou take an –x

bijou, *caillou*, *chou*, *genou*, *hibou*, *joujou*, *pou – hiboux*, *cailloux etc…*
Most **nouns ending -eu, -eau take an x**:
un château - des châteaux, *le jeu - les jeux*
Most **nouns ending -al change to -aux** in the plural:
un journal - deux journaux (also *le travail - les travaux*)
Nouns ending in -s, -x, -z don't change
un repas - des repas, *le prix - les prix*, *une merguez - des merguez*
And there are some **exceptions** to these patterns:
un oeil - deux yeux, *le ciel - les cieux*

Some nouns that describe people **change according to the gender of the person** they describe:
You add an 'e':
un ami - une amie *un Anglais - une Anglaise*
For masculine forms ending -**er, change to -ère**
un boulanger - une boulangère *le charcutier - la charcutière*
For some masculine forms ending -**eur, change to -euse or -trice**:
un coiffeur - une coiffeuse *un acteur - une actrice*
Nouns ending -**teur, change to -trice**:
un instituteur - une institutrice
For most masculine forms **ending -en, -an, -on you add -ne**:
le Parisien - la Parisienne *le paysan - la paysanne*
You **change -f to -ve, and -x to se**
un Juif - une Juive *un époux - une épouse*
Some feminine forms are **just irregular**:
le roi - la reine *un copain -une copine*
…and some **don't show any change** at all:
un enfant - une enfant *un élève - une élève*

The gender of the noun is **not always connected to the gender of the thing** it describes:
a victim is *une victime* (*David a été la victime du crime*) and
a person is always *une personne* (*la personne qui a raison est Marc)*

un livre	*a book*	une livre	*a pound*
un poste	*a job*	La Poste	*Post Office*